SHONGZA: THE TRAGIC CHRONICLE OF DESTINY AND CLAN HONOUR

Shongza: A Tangkhul Dramatic Novel

Author / Compiler: Tangkhul Literature Society

Publisher: Tangkhul Literature Society, Imphal

Year: 2007 | Genre: Novel (Upanyas) & Drama, Clan Honour & Tragedy

PREFACE & HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Shongza is a cornerstone text of Tangkhul higher education, combining the narrative breadth of a novel with the tense dialogue of classical Greek and Shakespearean tragedy. It probes the depths of ’ngashan’ (customary honour) and demonstrates the tragic human cost of unforgiving generational vendettas.

Archival Catalog Reference: TLS-TKH-NOVEL-SHONGZA

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CHAPTER 1: THE OATH OF VENGEANCE (KASHUNGWUI TUI-NGASHIK)

Summary: An ancient ancestral grievance sparks an oath between rival mountain chieftains....

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 1: Shongzana awui avashimwui thàng khuilaga kaphung kashangli yangsaye. Kum kachung ngaphalashu, awui avawui kathi chi awui lungli meikatha thada kazeiye. Ana awui uningnaobingli hang: 'Shangwui phashan kashiman-khalang, mikumona katha eina ringkapamsara? I tui-ngashik saye, mashung-kasa raser-ra!' Kha awui ava-va kachamna hang: 'Shongza, vashitsang-kasa eina vashitsang kacham rara; ngashankahaimilu!'

English Translation / Meaning:

Shongza unsheathed his father's ancestral dagger and gazed across the mountain frontiers. Though years had passed, the memory of his father's untimely demise burned like unquenchable fire in his breast. He told his clan brothers: 'If our lineage honour is degraded, how can we walk with head held high? I swear a sacred oath, justice shall be executed!' Yet his wise mother cautioned him: 'O Shongza, vengeance begetteth only destruction; grant forgiveness!'

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** phashan (noun): lineage honour, clan prestige, dignity**

Ex: Shangwui phashan.

*** vashitsang (noun): retribution, vendetta, blood vengeance**

Ex: Vashitsang eina.

*** ngashankahaimilu (verb): forgive, grant clemency and pardon**

Ex: Ngashankahaimilu!

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Honorific clan speech: 'Shangwui phashan' (dignity of the patriline).
- Hortative contrast: oath of revenge vs maternal plea for clemency.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Contrast Shongza's concept of justice with his mother's plea.

[?] Identify the traditional weapon featured in the scene.

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
This chapter illustrates quintessential Tangkhul cultural ethics, clan loyalty, and narrative style.

Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

CHAPTER 2: THE TRIAL BEFORE THE VILLAGE HANGVA (HANGVALI ADJUDICATION)

Summary: The village elders convene at the sacred megalith circle to arbitrate between th...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 2: Village Hangvawui elder-bingna lungphung kashang ngalemli pamkazipserie. Awungshina ceremonial tui-khak honsaye: 'Hao ngashanli mikumo kashikan khui mashuk-mana. Ithum tui-ngalung eina mashung-kasa sakakhui leisaye.' Shongzana awui tuitam chitheiye, kha rival chieftain-na restitution pay-sakhavai cattle kala woven Haora shawl offer saye. Hangvana tui khaklaga tui-ngalung treaty seal saye.

English Translation / Meaning:

The elders of the Hangva gathered beside the ancestral megalithic stone circle. The village chief pronounced the opening adjudication formula: 'Under customary law, no man may take the law into his own hands. We must establish reconciliation through righteous restitution.' Shongza presented his grievance, and the rival clan offered restitution of cattle and ceremonial Haora shawls. The council rendered its verdict, establishing a binding covenant of peace.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** lungphung (noun): megalithic stone platform, village council arena**

Ex: Lungphung ngalemli.

*** tui-ngalung (noun): restorative reconciliation, consensual treaty**

Ex: Tui-ngalung eina.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Legal adjudication verb: 'tui khaklaga' (having severed/adjudicated the dispute).
- Traditional restitution goods: cattle and woven textile regalia.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Explain the importance of the megalithic platform (lungphung) in Tangkhul jurisprudence.

[?] How does the Hangva resolve clan disputes?

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
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Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

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traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

CHAPTER 3: THE RECONCILED DAWN (ZINGKHAMATHAN KATHARA)

Summary: Shongza chooses reconciliation over bloodshed, breaking the cycle of vendettas f...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 3: Shongzana awui thàng sheath-li sheitsangserie. Ana theitserie: Mashung-kasana kashamli maphuma-mana, kha ringkapha kaphali phumye. Khor ceremonial pot eina athum khani clan-bingna ngayei tui honserie. Ukhrul kaphungli zingkhamathan shoklakha, village yaronaobingna mathat-eina Hao Pheichak pheitserie. Shongzana hang: 'Ithuwui naorap thot pupup ngacham eina ringkapamsara!'

English Translation / Meaning:

Shongza sheathed his dagger into its scabbard. He realized: True strength lies not in shedding blood, but in preserving life and future generations. Drinking from the ceremonial rice-beer horn, the two clans sealed their sacred alliance. As dawn broke over the peaks of Ukhrul, the youth joined in the festive circle dance. Shongza proclaimed: 'Our children and grandchildren shall abide in enduring peace!'

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** sheitsangserie (verb): sheathed back into the scabbard**

Ex: Thàng sheath-li sheitsang.

*** naorap (noun): descendants, posterity, offspring**

Ex: Ithuwui naorap thot pupup.

*** ngacham eina (adv): peacefully, in harmony**

Ex: Ngacham eina ringkapam.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Climactic resolution: sheathing the weapon symbolizes transition from warrior vendetta to civic peace.
- Blessing for posterity: 'naorap thot pupup'.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Discuss Shongza's internal character growth across the three chapters.

[?] Why is this work significant for undergraduate literature students?

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
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Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

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traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* phashan -- lineage honour, clan prestige, dignity
* vashitsang -- retribution, vendetta, blood vengeance
* ngashankahaimilu -- forgive, grant clemency and pardon
* lungphung -- megalithic stone platform, village council arena
* tui-ngalung -- restorative reconciliation, consensual treaty
* sheitsangserie -- sheathed back into the scabbard
* naorap -- descendants, posterity, offspring
* ngacham eina -- peacefully, in harmony

Preservation Colophon:

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